失败的胶水，成功的便利贴

The Glue That Failed Its Way to Success



黏得不牢的胶，为什么成了畅销文具？

READ 纯净阅读

CHECK 中文核对

LEARN 词汇记忆

RECALL 回想巩固

英文原文

In 1968 Spencer Silver, a scientist at 3M, set out to make a super-strong adhesive. The polymer he produced did something else. Its tiny spheres formed a layer with little tack, giving paper a temporary hold, so it would adhere, peel off, and be reapplied. To an inventor chasing strength, the formulation was a setback.

For five years Silver acted as its promoter within 3M's corporate ranks, in informal chats and at seminars. In his own summary, it was a solution without a problem. His perseverance met indifference. The unconventional material found no use, and the pursuit proved fruitless.

In 1974 Art Fry, a colleague who had heard one of those talks, faced a small annoyance at church. The paper bookmarks wedged in his choir's hymn book kept getting dislodged and falling out. The frustration gave Fry an idea. The unwanted adhesive could make a marker that would cling to a page, stay put, and leave it undamaged.

In 1977 the notes were test-marketed as Press 'n Peel in four American cities, where purchasers showed little enthusiasm. In 1978 3M's marketers staged a blitz in Boise, Idaho, and dispensed complimentary packets of notes to offices. More than 90 per cent of respondents who tried them said they would buy. After the coolness came a turnaround.

On 6 April 1980 the pads, rebranded as Post-it Notes, went on sale nationally in the US, and Canada and Europe followed in 1981. The stationery staple owes its signature canary tone to an unplanned twist. The laboratory next door had only leftover yellow paper.

中文译文

1968年，3M公司的科学家斯潘塞·西尔弗着手研制超强黏合剂，做出的聚合物却有另一种性能：微小球粒形成黏性较弱的涂层，让纸张暂时贴住，揭下后还能重新贴上。对追求黏合强度的发明者来说，这个配方却是一次挫折。

此后五年，西尔弗在3M内部不断推广它，在闲聊和研讨会上反复介绍。用他自己的话说，这是一个还没找到问题的解决方案。他的坚持换来的却是冷淡。这种不同寻常的材料始终找不到用途，探索似乎毫无结果。

1974年，听过他一次讲座的同事阿特·弗莱在教堂遇到一件烦心事：夹在唱诗班赞美诗集里的纸书签总是移位、掉落。这种挫败感让他想到，没人要的弱黏胶，也许能做出贴在书页上、不易移动、揭下又不伤纸的书签。

1977年，这种便条以Press’n Peel之名在美国四个城市试销，购买者反应冷淡。1978年，3M的营销人员在爱达荷州博伊西发动密集推广，向办公室免费派发一包包便条。试用过的受访者中，超过90%表示愿意购买。产品终于由冷遇迎来转机。

1980年4月6日，产品以“便利贴”的新名字在美国全国销售，1981年又进入加拿大和欧洲。如今这种文具已是常用品；它标志性的金丝雀黄色却纯属偶然：当时隔壁实验室只有剩下的黄纸。

超过90%说愿意购买，指试用后的受访者，不是所有消费者，也不是实际购买率。

核心词汇

先记这22项。连着下方的原文短语一起回想。

adhesive n.
黏合剂
a super-strong adhesive

polymer n.
聚合物
The polymer he produced

tack n.
黏着力
with little tack

temporary adj.
暂时的
a temporary hold

adhere v.
黏附
adhere, peel off, and be reapplied

peel off 动词短语
揭下；剥离
adhere, peel off, and be reapplied

formulation n.
配方
the formulation was a setback

setback n.
挫折
the formulation was a setback

perseverance n.
坚持不懈
His perseverance met indifference

indifference n.
冷淡；漠不关心
His perseverance met indifference

unconventional adj.
不同寻常的
The unconventional material

fruitless adj.
无结果的
the pursuit proved fruitless

dislodge v.
使移位
getting dislodged and falling out

frustration n.
挫败；懊恼
The frustration gave Fry an idea

cling to 动词短语
黏在；紧附
cling to a page

test-market v.
试销
the notes were test-marketed

enthusiasm n.
热情
purchasers showed little enthusiasm

dispense v.
分发
dispensed complimentary packets

complimentary adj.
免费赠送的
complimentary packets of notes

respondent n.
受访者
respondents who tried them

turnaround n.
转机；好转
After the coolness came a turnaround

staple n.
常用品
The stationery staple

文中词汇与搭配

补充词汇共41项。保留每个表达在本文中的意思。

set out to 动词短语
着手；开始做

super-strong adj.
超强的

something else 代词短语
别的东西；另一回事

sphere n.
球状颗粒

reapply v.
重新贴上

inventor n.
发明者

act as 动词短语
充当

promoter n.
推广者

corporate adj.
公司的

informal adj.
非正式的

seminar n.
研讨会

summary n.
概括；总结

solution n.
解决方案

find no use 动词短语
找不到用途

pursuit n.
探索；追求

annoyance n.
烦心事

bookmark n.
书签

wedge v.
夹住；塞入

choir n.
唱诗班

hymn n.
赞美诗

文中词汇与搭配 续

补充词汇共41项。保留每个表达在本文中的意思。

fall out 动词短语
掉出来

unwanted adj.
没人要的

stay put 动词短语
留在原处

undamaged adj.
完好无损的

note n.
便条

purchaser n.
购买者

marketer n.
营销人员

stage v.
组织；发起

blitz n.
密集攻势

packet n.
小包

coolness n.
冷淡

pad n.
便笺本

rebrand as 动词短语
更名为；改品牌为

Post-it Notes n.
便利贴（产品名）

nationally adv.
在全国

stationery n.
文具

signature adj.
标志性的

canary adj.
金丝雀黄色的

tone n.
色调

unplanned adj.
计划外的

leftover adj.
剩余的

回想与回顾

先遮住下方答案，再把四个词放回原文。

01 In 1968 Spencer Silver, a scientist at 3M, set out to make a super-strong _____.

02 His _____ met indifference.

03 In 1978 3M's marketers staged a blitz in Boise, Idaho, and dispensed _____ packets of notes to offices.

04 After the coolness came a _____.

文章主线

- 意外 1968年，3M的西尔弗想造超强胶，却做出由微小球粒组成的弱黏胶，纸张能贴住、揭下再贴。
- 用途 他在公司推广多年后，同事弗莱于1974年想到，用这种胶固定总从赞美诗集中滑落的书签，且不伤书页。
- 冷遇 1977年，这种便条在美国四个城市试销，消费者反应冷淡。
- 转机 1978年，3M在博伊西向办公室免费发试用品；试用过的受访者中，超过九成表示愿意购买。
- 上市 1980年，产品改名“便利贴”在全美上市，次年进入加拿大和欧洲；标志性的黄色，仅因隔壁实验室剩下黄纸。

参考答案　1 adhesive 2 perseverance 3 complimentary 4 turnaround